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10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A DATA ENGINEERING · PRACTICE WORKSHEET

CONCEPTUAL SERIES

Informatica

Name: ________ Cohort/Batch: ________ Date: ________ Score: ________

INFORMATICA PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 conceptual Q&A Data Engineering

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What is Informatica and what problem in Data Engineering does it solve? *Threat Model*

Q2 What are the core components or concepts in Informatica? *Architecture*

Q3 How does Informatica compare to its main alternatives? *Configuration*

Q4 How do you get started with Informatica for a new project? *Hardening*

Q5 What configuration options most affect Informatica's behavior in production? *SSO/IdP*

Q6 How does Informatica handle reliability and high availability? *Observability*

Q7 What observability does Informatica provide out of the box? *Lifecycle*

Q8 What are common performance bottlenecks in Informatica? *Compliance*

Q9 What security best practices apply when running Informatica? *Testing*

Q10 What mistakes do teams commonly make when adopting Informatica? *Tuning*

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 Informatica is a tool or platform that

Mitigation

Informatica is a tool or platform that automates or simplifies a specific concern in the Data Engineering domain, reducing manual effort and operational complexity for engineering teams.

A2 Informatica has key building blocks that work

Primitives

Informatica has key building blocks that work together: a configuration layer defines intent, a runtime layer enforces it, and an API or CLI layer allows operators to manage and observe the system.

A3 Informatica trades off simplicity against feature richness

Hardening

Informatica trades off simplicity against feature richness differently than its alternatives. Choose Informatica when its specific strengths performance, ecosystem, or ease of use align with your team's primary constraints.

A4 Install Informatica via its package manager or

Gotchas

Install Informatica via its package manager or binary release. Follow the quickstart to initialize a project, configure the minimal required settings, and run the default command to verify the setup works end-to-end.

A5 Production-critical settings typically include concurrency

Federation

Production-critical settings typically include concurrency limits, timeout values, retry policies, resource limits, and logging levels. Review the official production hardening guide before deploying.

A6 Informatica provides HA through leader election, replication,

Observability

Informatica provides HA through leader election, replication, or stateless horizontal scaling. Deploy at least two instances across availability zones and configure health checks for automatic failover.

A7 Informatica exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in

Automation

Informatica exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in dashboard), structured logs, and optionally distributed traces. Define SLOs on the key metrics and alert before users are affected.

A8 Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured

Governance

Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured connection pools, large payload sizes, insufficient worker threads, or missing caches. Profile with built-in diagnostics before optimizing.

A9 Run Informatica with the principle of least

Assessment

Run Informatica with the principle of least privilege, enable TLS for all communication, use a secrets manager for credentials, and keep the software patched to the latest stable release.

A10 Common pitfalls include skipping the documentation and

Optimization

Common pitfalls include skipping the documentation and learning the API by trial and error, using default configurations in production, lacking a runbook for operational issues, and not testing failover scenarios.